

Marketing by interrupting people isn't cost-effective any more.

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and in the process, learning more about a brand.

Contests in newspapers and magazines are a tried and tested formula to promote brands, but online contest-based consumer promotions are making waves in the world of advertising and promotions. Such contests are interactive, and are a major draw for potential consumers. For brand owners, it's a wonderful medium for an extensive and controlled brand awareness program.

C2W has a proven model of interactive marketing through entertaining contests and games that draw consumers willingly to interact with brands. Consumers spend quality time with a brand, enjoying themselves in the process, and the brand gets an unadulterated, uninterrupted, one-on-one interaction with its potential consumers.

Some of C2W's largest clients are Intel, MasterCard, Philips, Pepsi, Sony, Coca-Cola, Domino's Pizza, and Lufthansa, amongst several others.

How It Began, How It Matured

Agencyfaqs.com—one of India's largest B2B sites—reports that the idea of online contests clicked in the mind of a 29-year-old Kejriwal, who himself was crazy about contests. When he decided to start a business, he decided to do what he loved most. Kejriwal bid good-bye to his family's established hosiery business and began the journey of an online entrepreneur.

C2W was set in motion in August 1998, with an investment of Rs 9.5 lakhs from his personal savings. The rest was funded by venture capitalists at later stages. An avid competition freak, Kejriwal hated using competition postcards. Looking for an alternative, he happened to bump into the idea



Some of C2W's major clients



The Revenue Model

C2W has a simple, yet strong revenue model. It charges between Rs 1.5 and 5 lakh per month for a campaign, depending on the nature of the campaign. Each campaign lasts for a month and is refreshed the next month. The total time period offered to a brand is six months. The brand visibility in these types of contest sites is much higher than in a conventional medium, explains Kejriwal. For example, a consumer spends four to five minutes interacting with the brand on a one to one basis in an "unadulterated environment." Such interaction costs Rs 1-2 per contact for 240 to 300 seconds.

of starting an electronic post office of his own.

C2W started off without a revenue model. This was done keeping this in mind the fact that brand owners such as Hindustan Lever did not have an Internet presence those days. It also seemed logical, because prospective clients would, naturally, be wary of paying for an untested and untried concept.

After making "an average of 200 calls a day for three months with a success rate of getting only two brand owners over the phone," C2W got its first break with Gunendar Kapur at Hindustan Lever. He agreed to a contest for Kissan Annapurna Salt, which was branded the "Bright Kids" contest.

C2W started with a media barter model where it offered online contests for free, in lieu of C2W branding in all forms of communication—print ads, television supers, and MTV vee-jays cajoling viewers to "visit them at c2w.com!". This gave C2W the advantage of getting free promotion over all leading media properties in India.

After bagging the HLL contract, the greatest concern for C2W was, naturally, to bring in visitors. The Internet was in a nascent stage when Kejriwal started out, and what spurred him on was the knowledge that everyone, in general, loves to win prizes. The imperative was to make C2W contests so much fun that even fence sitters—those who would not participate in the "certain knowledge" that they would never win a prize—would become avid contestants just for the thrill.

"The idea is to help consumers and participants get out of the stupid slogan contests and actually participate in interactive campaigns. We have successfully created a new community of "winnaholics," and this community comprises not just die-hard contest types, but also housewives, lawyers, merchants and investment bankers, stockbrokers, and even a few retired people! C2W has a registered user base of 9,68,000 Indian members, with 32,000 new unique members joining every month," claims Kejriwal.

After establishing its reputation as a successful model for online contests over two years, revenues started trickling in for C2W. By the end of the first quarter of year 2000-01, that is, in

L'Oréal and Colgate Palmolive

L'Oréal needed to promote its Maybelline Copper Collection. The newly launched Copper Collection was to be introduced to young female consumers in an innovative manner that ensured that its different shades were clearly communicated to the target audience.

What C2W did was an online promotion that immersed consumers in a game involving Copper shades as clues in a conversation. The prize offered was L'Oréal gift hampers.

The campaign introduced each category of the new product and generated brand awareness to the core target audience in an interactive format. Responses lasted for three minutes each, ensuring high quality time spent with the promotion.

Colgate Palmolive wanted to promote its Fresh Energy Gel—they wanted to create high-impact online visibility for the Gel, which was a newly launched variant.

C2W's solution was a unique and innovative product—a "soap opera" on the Internet called sit.com. It was a first-of-its-kind branded solution, and generated huge publicity and "viral pull." This was one of the most successful promotions on C2W—it ran for nine months, while typically each brand promotion lasts a month; and it aggregated a huge fan following in the C2W community. C2W claims that consumers *actually became loyal* to the branded solution, and regularly came back for more.